

Matthew Cobbing

Technical Lead

[\[cobbing.dev\]](#) . matthew@cobbing.dev . [GitHub](#) . [LinkedIn](#) . [Medium](#)

London, United Kingdom

SUMMARY

I'm a Technical Lead with 7+ years of experience building reliable, scalable, and maintainable web platforms. I thrive on designing clear architectures, improving engineering practices, and leading teams through complex technical challenges. You can find my personal projects and open source work on my [portfolio site](#).

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Go, Rust, TypeScript

Backend & Architecture: Microservices, RESTful APIs, GraphQL, gRPC, Event-Driven Architecture, Test-Driven Development

Databases: PostgreSQL, PostGIS, DynamoDB

Cloud & DevOps: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD Pipelines, GitLab CI/CD, Buildkite

Current Learning: Open-source contributor to the Gleam programming language compiler alongside contributions to various Go and Rust open-source projects

EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead, Perkbox

October 2020 – Present, London

At Perkbox I worked across the backend as part of the Customers team, building products used by company administrators and leading key platform initiatives. I was promoted twice, first to Senior Software Engineer and then to Backend Technical Lead, where I shaped backend standards and guided engineers across multiple teams. I also played a major role in the post-merger migration of the Vivup platform.

Key Responsibilities:

- Designed and built the HR auto-provisioning system using an event-driven architecture with queued user events, Go services, and gRPC integration
- Developed and maintained backend features for the admin platform used by thousands of customers
- Drove adoption of Rust internally and contributed to multiple Rust-based services
- Led backend work for the Vivup monolith migration onto the Perkbox platform after the company merger
- Mentored engineers, improved documentation, and championed better engineering practices including TDD and reliability-focused development
- As Backend Technical Lead, guided technical decisions, set backend standards, and supported engineers across the organisation

Impact:

- Improved the overall Perkbox platform by modernising backend services, reducing tech debt, and helping standardise patterns that made systems more reliable and easier to evolve
- Reduced operational overhead by automating user management across HR ecosystems
- Helped unify two companies' products post-merger, enabling a smoother customer transition
- Improved engineering consistency and backend quality through leadership, mentorship, and standards-setting
- Drove early adoption of Rust

Technologies: Go, Rust, TypeScript, React, gRPC, GraphQL, REST, SQS, SNS, DynamoDB, PostgreSQL, AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD, Event Bus

Software Engineer, Nando's

January 2019 – October 2020, London

At Nando's I was one of the first permanent engineers brought in to build the new in-house ordering platform. I helped shape the early architecture and technology choices, including introducing Go for backend services, and worked across the full stack to deliver the core foundations of the platform.

Key Responsibilities:

- Restaurant API in Go and GraphQL with PostgreSQL/PostGIS for location-based restaurant lookup
- Payments API in Go integrating with external providers for secure order payments
- Menu API in Rust and GraphQL, powered by a headless CMS for non-technical menu editing
- Built internal React tools used daily by restaurant staff
- Helped design and maintain the microservices platform on GCP, working with Kubernetes, Terraform, Buildkite, Docker and Istio

Impact:

- Helped Nando's bring their ordering system fully in-house, reducing third-party dependency and enabling faster product iteration
- Shaped the early technical direction of the team during a critical greenfield phase
- Delivered reliable backend services that powered real customer orders across the UK
- Enabled restaurant teams to operate more efficiently through intuitive internal tools

Technologies: Go, Rust, TypeScript, React, GraphQL, REST, PostgreSQL, PostGIS, Kubernetes, Docker, Istio, Terraform, Buildkite, Google Cloud Platform

Graduate Engineer → Software Development Engineer, Anritsu

September 2014 – September 2016, Luton

At Anritsu I joined as a Graduate Engineer in a rotation scheme across support, testing, integration, and software development, giving me end-to-end exposure to the full development lifecycle. I was later promoted to a Software Development Engineer working on core features for Anritsu's RTD product.

Key Responsibilities:

- Fixed bugs and delivered new UI features in Java for the RTD telecoms testing suite
- Investigated customer issues, replicated failures, identified root causes, and wrote tests to prevent regressions
- Worked in Agile teams across support, test, integration, and development during the graduate rotation
- Used Jenkins and Perforce as part of day-to-day CI and version control workflows

Impact:

- Strengthened product stability through consistent debugging, testing, and defect prevention
- Gained broad telecoms and software lifecycle experience that informed later engineering roles
- Contributed to a widely used mobile testing product relied on by major device manufacturers

Technologies: Java, Jenkins, Perforce, Agile

EDUCATION

MEng Electrical and Electronic Engineering

Loughborough University, October 2010 – June 2014